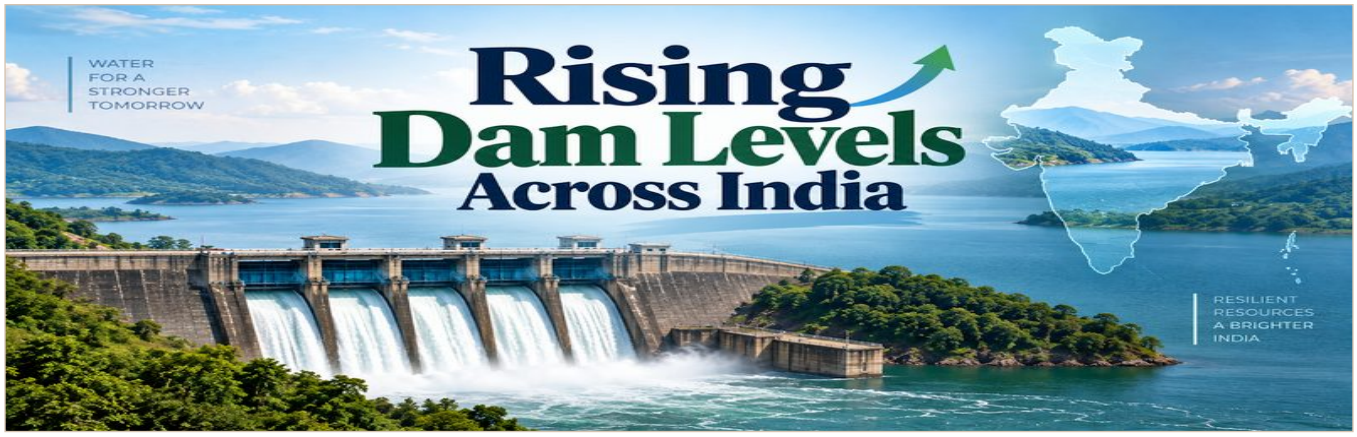


Akella Raghavendra Sir
Founder & Chief Mentor

[GS I - GEOGRAPHY | GS II - GOVERNANCE | GS III - ENVIRONMENT] | **Publication Date: 05/09/2026**

Rising Dam Levels Across India



India's reservoir storage shows regional gains despite deficient monsoon rainfall, highlighting water availability, irrigation needs, regional disparities, and the importance of sustainable reservoir management.

Syllabus Areas:

GS I - Geography

GS II - Governance

GS III - Environment

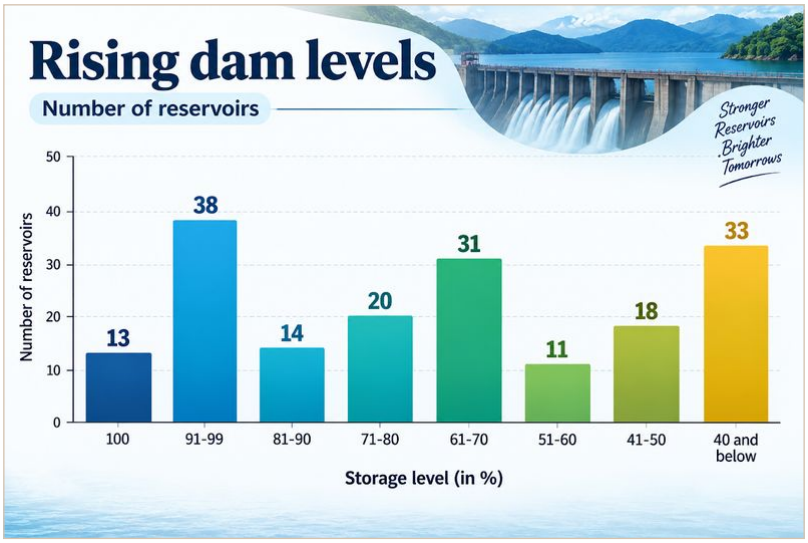
India's reservoir storage is in focus amid a deficient monsoon, with Central and Western regions exceeding 80% capacity, while overall storage remains below last year's level and the 10-year average.

Also Read: Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari (JSJB)

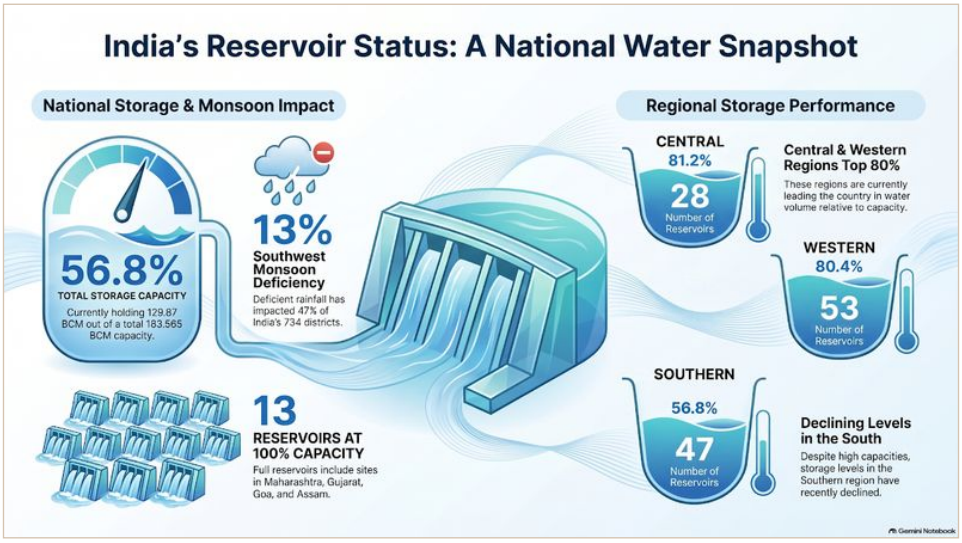
What is a Reservoir?

A **reservoir is a large, artificial or natural storage area used to collect and store water**, usually created by building a **dam across a river**.

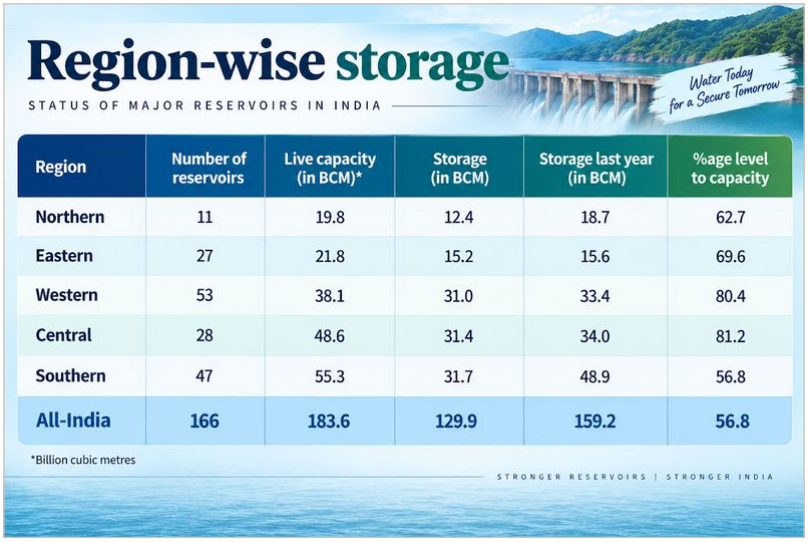




- **30%+ of 166 major reservoirs** have storage above **80% of capacity**.
- **South-West monsoon was 13% deficient** as of September 3.
- **47% of 734 districts** received deficient rainfall.
- **13 reservoirs were full**, including **5 in Maharashtra**; **51 remained below 50%** capacity.
- Continued rainfall in the coming days may **further improve reservoir storage**.



- **Central (81.2%) and Western (80.4%) regions** recorded the highest storage levels.
- Overall reservoir storage stood at **56.76%**, or **129.87 BCM** of 183.565 BCM capacity.
- **4 of 5 regions** had storage above **60%**, but Southern storage declined.
- Overall storage remained **below both last year's level and the 10-year average**.



Region-wise storage

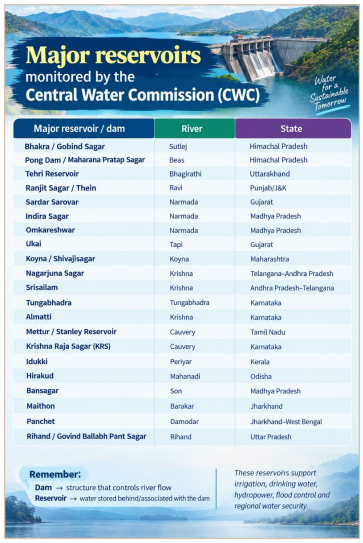
STATUS OF MAJOR RESERVOIRS IN INDIA

Water Today for a Secure Tomorrow

Region	Number of reservoirs	Live capacity (in BCM)*	Storage (in BCM)	Storage last year (in BCM)	%age level to capacity
Northern	11	19.8	12.4	18.7	62.7
Eastern	27	21.8	15.2	15.6	69.6
Western	53	38.1	31.0	33.4	80.4
Central	28	48.6	31.4	34.0	81.2
Southern	47	55.3	31.7	48.9	56.8
All-India	**166**	**183.6**	**129.9**	**159.2**	**56.8**

*Billion cubic metres

STRONGER RESERVOIRS | STRONGER INDIA



Major reservoirs monitored by the Central Water Commission (CWC)

Water for a Sustainable Tomorrow

Major reservoir / dam	River	State
Bhakra / Gobind Sagar	Sutlej	Himachal Pradesh
Pong Dam / Maharana Pratap Sagar	Beas	Himachal Pradesh
Tehri Reservoir	Bhagirathi	Uttarakhand
Ranjit Sagar / Thein	Ravi	Punjab/J&K
Sardar Sarovar	Narmada	Gujarat
Indira Sagar	Narmada	Madhya Pradesh
Omkareshwar	Narmada	Madhya Pradesh
Ukai	Tapi	Gujarat
Koyna / Shivajisagar	Koyna	Maharashtra
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna	Telangana-Andhra Pradesh
Srisailam	Krishna	Andhra Pradesh-Telangana
Tungabhadra	Tungabhadra	Karnataka
Almatti	Krishna	Karnataka
Mettur / Stanley Reservoir	Cauvery	Tamil Nadu
Krishna Raja Sagar (KRS)	Cauvery	Karnataka
Idukki	Periyar	Kerala
Hirakud	Mahanadi	Odisha
Bansagar	Son	Madhya Pradesh
Maithon	Barakar	Jharkhand
Panchet	Damodar	Jharkhand-West Bengal
Rihand / Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar	Rihand	Uttar Pradesh

Remember:
Dam → structure that controls river flow
Reservoir → water stored behind/associated with the dam

These reservoirs support irrigation, drinking water, hydropower, flood control and regional water security.